

Research Degree Award Rules — Rules Notification

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Issued in 2022 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/RUL/2022/018, this rules notification establishes the arrangements supporting Research Degree Award Rules. In scope are Research Degree, Thesis, Supervision, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Context and Background

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Research Degree as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present rules notification responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

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Object and Purpose

This rules notification is intended to translate the objectives of Research Degree Award Rules into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Research Degree is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

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Objectives

The principal objectives are to strengthen Research Degree, harmonise institutional approaches to Thesis, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Research Degree, Thesis, Supervision, with clear lines of accountability.

Scope

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Research Degree within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

Core Provisions

Institutions are required to integrate Research Degree, Thesis into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Research Degree, disclosure of material information to Higher Education Department, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Implementation Arrangements

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Higher Education Department in line with the prescribed cycle.

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

Institutional Responsibilities

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Research Degree, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Performance Monitoring

Higher Education Department will review implementation against agreed indicators, publish consolidated outcomes, and engage institutions that require additional support or show exemplary practice.

Closing Note

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.